- A simple sentence has just one independent clause – it has only one subject and one predicate.
- A simple sentence may have subject complements, object complements, adverbial phrases and non-finite verbs.

Task 1

Pick out the finite verbs in the following sentences:

a) You can solve this problem in different ways.

b) The professor has been working on the last chapter of the book since March.

c) Despite being a celebrity, Ravi mingles easily with everyone.

d) You must speak clearly to make yourself understood.

e) The chairman being away, the clerk is unable to approve the proposal.

f) Getting down from the car, the Chief Guest walked towards the dais amidst applause.

g) The old man struggled to walk without support.

h) In case of emergency, please contact this number.

i) The sun having set, the temperature fell rapidly.

j) But for your help, I could not have completed the assignment.

Task 2

Read the following passage and identify the simple sentences.

Sunflowers turn according to the position of the sun. In other words, they ' chase the light'. Have you ever wondered what happens on cloudy, rainy days when the sun is completely covered by clouds? If you think the sunflower withers or turns its head towards the ground, you are completely mistaken. Do you know what happens? Sunflowers turn to each other to share their energy. Learning from Nature, we too should support and empower each other.

b) Complex sentence

Let us recall the differences between a phrase and a clause and learn to identify Main and Subordinate clauses.

Phrase

i. A phrase is a group of words without a finite verb in it.

ii. It does not give complete sense.

Examples : my new watch, a barking dog, the wise, the brave etc.

Clause

i. A clause is a group of words with a finite verb in it.

ii. It may or may not make complete sense.

Examples : my watch that is new, a dog that is barking, people who are wise, those who are brave

Look at the following sentence:

I have lost the watch that you gave me.

I have lost the watch	- Main clause (the clause stands on its own)
that you gave me	- Subordinate clause (the clause depends on the Main clause for its meaning to be completed)

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